



COST-MANDATE MOTION /// ONE-OFF STRIKE ROOM

Bell Canada

Buying-committee strike sequences for a company that named the call centre inside its own savings thesis, and told investors the cuts funding it may be draining the transformation.

\$1.5B

SAVINGS BY
2028, CALL
CENTRE NAMED
(INVESTOR
DAY)

240M

CUSTOMER
INTERACTIONS
A YEAR
(ANNUAL
REPORT)

**Over
half**

CARE AGENTS
UNDER AI
QUALITY MGMT
(THEIR
NUMBER)

**Apr
2027**

CRTC SELF-
SERVE
COMPLIANCE
DEADLINE

Why Bell, why now

Bell Canada / BCE Inc. Canada's largest communications company. Confirmed non-customer: screened against Nathan's Salesforce Active Customer Account Report (Jul 10, 2026). Bell and BCE do not appear. Royal Bank of Canada and Rogers Communications Canada do appear as customers, so neither may be named in any Bell-facing material.

The forcing function

On October 14, 2025, at its Investor Day, BCE committed publicly to **\$1.5 billion in cost savings by 2028**. Bell's own release names where the money comes from, verbatim:

"expanding self-serve capabilities, new call centre and digital investments, other improvements to the customer service experience"

and

"management workforce reductions including attrition and retirements"

This is what makes Bell the sharpest of the three accounts Nathan sent. Most cost mandates have to be inferred from an efficiency ratio or a layoff headline, and the connection to customer operations is ours to argue. Bell put the call centre inside the savings thesis itself, in a dated board-level commitment, with a deadline. The customer-operations executive at Bell is personally accountable for delivering a number the market is already holding the company to.

The tension the whole sequence hangs on

BCE's own 2025 Annual Information Form (Mar 5, 2026) lists as a risk factor:

"the potential deterioration in employee morale and engagement resulting from staff reductions, cost reductions or reorganizations, and the de-prioritization of transformation initiatives due to staff reductions"

Bell has told its own investors that the reductions funding the cost program may be draining the capacity to deliver the transformation the cost program depends on. That

gap is the entire opening. Capacity recovered from inside the existing headcount is the one lever that books against the mandate without widening that risk, and the one that does not trade against what Bell owes the CRTC by April 2027.

The vise closing around it

- **CRTC Telecom Regulatory Policy 2026-78** (decided Apr 24, 2026) requires every provider to give customers a self-service mechanism to modify and cancel plans, to send written confirmation of every self-service action, and prohibits charging any fee for access to customer service channels. **Compliance deadline: April 26, 2027.**
- **CRTC 2026-43** (Mar 12, 2026) already removed activation and modification fees, with a June 12, 2026 deadline now passed. The CRTC explicitly acknowledged providers needed transition time to update billing systems.
- Bell must cut cost, improve service, and re-plumb customer-facing operations for a regulatory date, all in the same eighteen months.

What Bell has disclosed about its own operations

All from the 2025 BCE Integrated Annual Report (dated Mar 5, 2026):

- **"over 240 million customer interactions each year"**
- Virtual Assistant handled **15 million interactions in 2025**, resolving more than half without a live agent
- Virtual Repair Tool has eliminated **over one million support calls** since launch
- **"AI-enabled quality management now supports evaluations for over half of customer-care agents"**

That last line is the most operationally useful sentence Bell has published. It confirms agent-level quality data already exists and is being acted on, and it confirms the coverage is partial. Bell has built the measurement layer and has not yet closed the loop from measurement to action across the whole floor.

Recent financial context (company-disclosed)

- FY2025 severance costs **\$517 million** (BCE Q4/full-year results, Feb 5, 2026)
- FY2025 adjusted EBITDA margin **43.6%**, highest annual level in 30+ years (same release)
- 2026 adjusted EPS growth guidance of **(11%) to (5%)**, the pressure sitting behind the cost program (same release)
- Q1 2026 operating costs up 4.9%, "partially offset by lower labour costs and technology and automation-enabled operating efficiencies" (BCE Q1 2026 results, May 7, 2026)

- CEO Mirko Bibic, May 7, 2026: "**simplify the business**"; on the voice virtual assistant across Bell, Virgin Plus and Lucky Mobile, supporting "**lower cost to serve**"
- CFO Curtis Millen, May 7, 2026: "Margin performance reflects continued operating discipline and efficiencies within the business."

Calendar anchor

BCE reports Q2 2026 on August 6, 2026. As of the build date, Q2 is not yet reported and the most recent reported quarter is Q1 2026 (May 7). On a Day 1 start of Wednesday July 29, Touch 4 lands Wednesday August 5, the day before the print, and Touch 5 lands Monday August 10, after it.

If this sequence goes out after August 6, the Q2 language must be re-run before sending. The cost narrative will have been restated on that call and the copy should reflect what was actually said, not what was said in May. Flagged in the claims basis below.

Buying committee

Eight seats, all sourced live via Clay on July 29, 2026 and all emails swept through ZeroBounce the same day before any copy was written.

#	NAME	TITLE	TIER	EMAIL	ZB STATUS	ANGLE
1	Hadeer Hassaan	EVP, Chief Information & Customer Experience Officer	4 (exec sponsor)	hadeer.hassaan@bell.ca	Valid, no flags	Owns both the technology function and the customer experience function. The "over half of customer-care agents" number is hers. Extended arc.
2	James Beresford	Senior Vice President Customer Operations	1 (floor owner)	james.beresford@bell.ca	Valid, no flags	The 240 million interactions run through his organization. Extended arc.
3	Blaik Kirby	Group President, Consumer and SMB	2 (economic)	blaik.kirby@bell.ca	Valid, no flags	Owns the consumer P&L the service cost sits inside, and the book the CRTC deadline lands on.
4	Francis Plante	VP Finance, Corporate Planning, Finance Transformation & Capital Investments	2 (economic)	francis.plante@bell.ca	Valid, no flags	Owns the economics of the transformation. The \$517M bought a run rate he now has to defend.

5	Maria Ferranti	Vice President Customer Experience	1 (champion)	maria.ferranti@bell.ca	Valid, no flags	The containment story and the experience the automation does not reach.
6	Melissa Kozakowski	Vice President, Customer Experience Operations, Bell Business Markets	1 (champion)	melissa.kozakowski@bell.ca	Valid, no flags	Business-market CX operations. Enterprise commitments, a different failure mode than consumer. Twelve months in seat (started July 2025).
7	Priya Chellasamy	Senior Manager, Contact Center AI Technology Enablement	3 (technical)	priya.chellasamy@bell.ca	Valid, no flags	The enablement seat between deployed AI and floor results. Carries the single humility clause.
8	Ann Cullingham (Lee)	Director, Customer Operations	5 (operational)	Unresolved	Not swept	Clay waterfall did not resolve, likely the Cullingham/Lee surname split. LinkedIn-first, email queued on validation.

ZeroBounce sweep, July 29, 2026: 7 of 7 valid, zero catch-all or role-based sub-status flags. Run in a fresh scratch workbook `OneOff_ZB_Sweep_Jul29` , table `Bell_Committee_ZB` . 0.7 credits, page-verified against the run panel. The prior scratch table `OneOff_CardinalHealth_ZB_Jul15` no longer exists in the workspace and a new one was created.

bell.ca returned clean on every address with no catch-all, which is a materially better deliverability position than Blue Shield of California, where six of eight came back catch-all. The addresses are trustworthy here.

Bench, not sequenced: Robert (Robbie) Osman, Director Customer Experience Operation, robert.osman@bell.ca, three months in seat as of the build date. Sophie Lamontagne, GM Bell Subsidiaries and ICG Customer Care, sophie.lamontagne@bell.ca, a distinct book worth a separate play. Mario Barbieri, VP Operations, three months in seat. Matt MacEwen, SVP Finance.

What reps can and cannot say

Say

- Anything Bell has published, with the date attached. The \$1.5B by 2028 target and its stated drivers, the 240 million interactions, the "over half of customer-care agents" line, the \$517M severance, the "simplify the business" and "lower cost to serve" quotes, the 2026 EPS guidance, the CRTC deadlines.
- Intradiem's approved positioning if a frame is needed: Dynamic Workforce Orchestration, spanning contact centre and back office. That positioning statement is the whole of what is cleared here. **No platform headcount figure, no retention or growth percentage, no company statistic of any kind** — the Value Repository was frozen as a prospect-facing source on Jul 21 2026 (Matt Graves, with Naveen), and the cleared-to-ship allowlist is three items: the DWO positioning statement, the Humana webinar claims in the bullet below, and public CMS Star Ratings math with the estimate label attached (not applicable to Bell). Anything else, including any figure sourced from intradiem.com or a press release, is **[UNVERIFIED]** for prospect-facing use until cleared.
- The Humana result (7X ROI five years in, approximately two hours of capacity per agent per month) is publicly approved and named. **Replies and objection handling only, never in a cold touch.** This carries the Cardinal Health rule forward.
- Contact centre and back office together. Bell's billing operations, order provisioning and dispatch are as much of the story as the phone queue.

Do not say

- **No idle-time percentage. No efficiency statistic of any kind.** Blocked in the Value Repository, and the cost-mandate motion frames from the prospect's own stated pressure rather than a manufactured number.
- **No ROI, savings or payback figure for Bell.** No modelled dollar amount, no "typical customer sees" claim.
- **No Bell headcount, agent count or call-centre location.** Bell does not disclose them. Neither the Integrated Annual Report nor the Annual Information Form contains an agent count. Third-party tracker estimates are not usable.
- **No CCTS complaint numbers.** The Bell-specific figure reaches us through a secondary outlet rendering regulator data rather than the CCTS report itself. It is directionally real and it is not clean enough to put in front of a Bell executive. Left out of every message on purpose.
- **No union or layoff framing.** The Unifor statements are real and quoting a company's job cuts back at its executives is hostile, not insightful. Where reductions come up, it is Bell's own language and Bell's own disclosed number, on the finance seat only.

- **No Genesys assumption.** Bell resells Genesys Cloud commercially, including a Shared Services Canada federal contact centre contract announced March 3, 2026. That is Bell's sell-side business. It is not evidence of what Bell runs for its own 240 million interactions, and stating otherwise in a message to a Bell technology executive would end the conversation.
- **No RBC, no Rogers.** Both are customers. Neither gets named.
- **No wait time, handle time or first-contact-resolution claim about Bell.** Unverified.

Cadence and committee choreography

Five-touch multi-channel core across about nine business days from each contact's entry day. Two contacts run the extended arc.

- **Touch 1 (Day 1)** Email. Why-now plus one hook specific to that seat.
- **Touch 2 (Day 2)** LinkedIn connection request carrying the opener.
- **Touch 3 (Day 4)** Voicemail plus a LinkedIn message the same day. **Every voicemail has a live-answer script behind it.** If they pick up, the rep does not read the voicemail out loud.
- **Touch 4 (Day 6)** Email. A genuinely new second angle.
- **Touch 5 (Day 9)** Breakup email.

Extended arc on Hassaan and Beresford: call #1 with a full script, call #2 shorter, a pattern interrupt, then a hail-mary before the breakup. Escalation runs soft to direct to persistent. The order does not invert to fit a calendar.

Staggered entry

DAY	CONTACTS ENTERING
Day 1	James Beresford, Maria Ferranti, Ann Cullingham (LinkedIn only)
Day 2	Priya Chellasamy, Melissa Kozakowski
Day 3	Francis Plante
Day 4	Hadeer Hassaan, Blaik Kirby

The floor and champion layer go first so that by the time the executive sponsors enter on Day 4, the outreach has had time to surface internally through the people who would mention it.

Deliverability

Seven addresses into bell.ca inside four days is a real pattern-flag risk regardless of copy quality. The sweep came back clean with no catch-all, so placement is the only variable left. Every contact has a different subject line, no two openers share a structure, sends stagger across the day rather than clustering, and Ann Cullingham leads on LinkedIn with her email queued behind validation.

Hadeer Hassaan

EVP, Chief Information & Customer
Experience Officer

EXTENDED ARC

Hook. She is the only Bell executive whose title spans both technology and customer experience, which means the "call centre and digital investments" line in the savings thesis and the AI adoption line land on the same desk. She has publicly staked her position on AI in customer service.

TOUCH 1 • DAY 4 • EMAIL

the half you have not covered yet

Hadeer, Bell's annual report says AI-enabled quality management now supports evaluations for over half of customer-care agents. The half already covered is where the measurement works. The half that is not is where the \$1.5 billion has to come from next, and it is the harder half, because coverage was never the constraint. Acting on what the measurement finds, in the moment, at the scale of 240 million interactions, is.

Intradiem runs workforce orchestration across the contact centre and the back office, turning real-time conditions into action on the floor rather than a report after the shift. Twenty minutes on where that second half typically stalls for an operation your size?

{{sender}}

TOUCH 2 • DAY 5 • LINKEDIN CONNECTION REQUEST

Hadeer, your annual report line about AI-enabled quality management reaching over half of care agents is the most interesting operational sentence Bell published this year. I work the gap between what that measurement finds and what actually changes on the floor. Would value connecting.

TOUCH 3 • DAY 7 • VOICEMAIL

Hadeer, this is {{sender}} with Intradiem. I sent you a note about the line in Bell's annual report on AI-enabled quality management covering over half your care agents, and why the second half tends to be a different problem than the first. Real-time action on the floor is what we do. I am at [number], or the email is easy to reply to. Thanks Hadeer.

TOUCH 3 • DAY 7 • LIVE-ANSWER SCRIPT, IF SHE PICKS UP

OPENER

Hadeer, {{sender}} with Intradiem. You have thirty seconds and then you can tell me whether to keep going.

THE THIRTY SECONDS

Bell published that AI-enabled quality management now covers over half your care agents. Every operation I see gets that first half done and then finds the second half is not a coverage problem, it is an action problem. The evaluation tells you what happened after it happened. We work the other side of that, taking real-time conditions and turning them into something the agent or the back office actually does while the shift is still running. Against a \$1.5 billion target where Bell itself named the call centre, that is capacity you already own.

CLOSE

Worth twenty minutes to see where it usually breaks at your scale? I can work around whatever your calendar looks like this month.

TOUCH 3 • DAY 7 • LINKEDIN MESSAGE

Hadeer, left you a voicemail as well. Short version: the second half of that quality-management coverage is usually a different problem than the first, because the constraint moves from measuring to acting. Twenty minutes on where that shows up at 240 million interactions?

TOUCH 4 • DAY 9 • EMAIL

April 2027

Hadeer, a second thought, on the deadline rather than the target. The CRTC's self-service ruling gives every provider until April 26, 2027 to let customers modify and cancel without a live representative, with written confirmation on every action and no fee for reaching customer service at all.

That date pulls in the opposite direction from the cost program for the next eighteen months. Self-serve reduces contacts, and the contacts that survive it are the harder ones, arriving at a floor that is meant to be getting cheaper at the same time. The work that does not trade against either one is capacity recovered from inside the operation you already have.

Twenty minutes to walk what that looks like between now and the compliance date?

{{sender}}

TOUCH 5 • DAY 11 • CALL #1, FULL SCRIPT

OPENER

Hadeer, {{sender}} with Intradiem. I have sent a couple of notes and I would rather just ask you directly than send a third.

THE FRAME

Bell has a \$1.5 billion target with the call centre named inside it, a CRTC self-service deadline in April 2027, and a line in your own annual information form about transformation initiatives being de-prioritized because of staff reductions. Those three things do not resolve each other. The only lever I know that moves all three in the same direction is capacity recovered from the headcount already on the floor, because it does not cost a reduction and it does not cost service.

THE ASK

I am not asking you to evaluate anything. Twenty minutes, and if the answer is that Bell has this covered, you will have spent twenty minutes and I will stop.

IF SHE PUSHES ON WHAT IT ACTUALLY IS

We sit on top of whatever workforce management and contact centre platform you already run. We do not replace them. We take the real-time state of the floor and trigger the action, coaching, training, offline work, back-office queues, in the moment rather than in a report.

TOUCH 6 • DAY 13 • CALL #2, SHORT

Hadeer, {{sender}} with Intradiem again. One question and I will let you go. Between now and April 2027, is anybody at Bell working the capacity side of that equation rather than the deflection side? If the answer is yes I will stop calling. If it is not obvious, that is the twenty minutes I am asking for.

TOUCH 7 • DAY 15 • PATTERN INTERRUPT, LINKEDIN MESSAGE

Hadeer, you said last year that if you have not started on AI in customer experience already, you are late. Agreed. The part I would push on is that starting and finishing are different problems, and the second half of a floor is where most programs find that out. Still think the twenty minutes is worth it.

one line from your own filing

Hadeer, this is my last one.

BCE's annual information form lists, as a risk, the de-prioritization of transformation initiatives due to staff reductions. Bell wrote that about itself, for investors, in March. It is the most honest description of the problem I have read from any operator this year, and it is exactly the problem we solve, because capacity recovered from the existing floor is the only kind that does not deepen the risk it is meant to relieve.

If that lands, twenty minutes. If it does not, I have made my case and I will leave you alone.

{{sender}}

leaving it here

Hadeer, I will stop.

One parting thought. The half of your care agents already under AI-enabled quality management is the half where Bell proved the measurement works. That was the expensive part and it is done. The second half is not a bigger version of the first, it is the moment the question changes from what happened to what should happen right now, and operations that treat it as more of the same tend to stall there for a year.

When that becomes the live question, the real-time execution layer is where I would start.

{{sender}}

SEAT 2 OF 8

TIER 1

FLOOR OWNER

ENTRY DAY 1

EXTENDED ARC

James Beresford

Senior Vice President Customer
Operations

Hook. The 240 million interactions Bell publishes are his organization's volume. He is the person who has to hold service while the cost line comes down.

TOUCH 1 • DAY 1 • EMAIL

240 million, and a number that has to come down

James, Bell publishes over 240 million customer interactions a year and a \$1.5 billion savings target that names the call centre as one of the places it comes from. You are the person those two sentences meet in.

Most operations answer that with deflection, which works until the contacts that survive it are the hard ones and the floor handling them is smaller. The other lever is the capacity already sitting inside the shift, the time between contacts and around them, which is a scheduling and execution problem rather than a headcount one. Intradiem orchestrates that across the contact centre and the back office in real time.

Twenty minutes on where that capacity usually hides at your volume?

{{sender}}

TOUCH 2 • DAY 2 • LINKEDIN CONNECTION REQUEST

James, I work the operations side of cost programs in customer service, specifically the part where the target lands on the floor and service still has to hold. Given you run Bell's customer operations, would value connecting.

TOUCH 3 • DAY 4 • VOICEMAIL

James, this is {{sender}} with Intradiem. I sent a note on the 240 million interactions and the \$1.5 billion, and the fact that you are where those two meet. There is a capacity lever inside the shift that most cost programs never touch. I can show you where it usually sits. I am at [number]. Thanks James.

TOUCH 3 • DAY 4 • LIVE-ANSWER SCRIPT, IF HE PICKS UP

OPENER

James, {{sender}} with Intradiem. Thirty seconds and you can tell me to go away.

THE THIRTY SECONDS

Bell has a \$1.5 billion target and named the call centre as a source. You are running 240 million interactions against that. Every operation I work with attacks it two ways, deflect more and cut heads, and both of those make your floor harder to run. The third lever is the capacity that already exists inside the shifts you are paying for, the fragments between contacts and around them that are too short for a supervisor to do anything with but not too short for a system that is watching in real time. That is what we orchestrate, across the contact centre and the back office both.

CLOSE

Twenty minutes and I will show you where that usually sits in an operation your size. Worth it?

TOUCH 3 • DAY 4 • LINKEDIN MESSAGE

James, left you a voicemail too. Short version: there is capacity inside your existing shifts that cost programs never reach because it lives in fragments too small to schedule manually. That is the part we work. Twenty minutes?

TOUCH 4 • DAY 6 • EMAIL

what the back office is doing to your queue

James, one angle I did not put in the first note.

The CRTC removed activation and modification fees in June and gave providers explicit transition time to update billing systems, which is a regulator saying out loud that this lands on back-office processing before it lands anywhere else. Billing and order work that slips does not stay in the back office. It comes back as a call, and it arrives at the front line as the expensive kind of contact, the one that is already a complaint.

Treating the contact centre and the back office as one workforce is the difference between absorbing that and being surprised by it. Twenty minutes on how that flows through an operation at Bell's scale?

{{sender}}

TOUCH 5 • DAY 9 • CALL #1, FULL SCRIPT

OPENER

James, {{sender}} with Intradiem. I have sent a couple of notes. Rather than send a third I would rather just ask.

THE FRAME

You are holding service across 240 million interactions while a \$1.5 billion target works its way through your cost line, and Bell's own filings say the reductions are putting the transformation work at risk. I do not think that is a resourcing argument you are going to win by asking for people. I think the only version of it that works is capacity you already have and cannot currently reach.

THE ASK

Twenty minutes. I will show you where it sits in an operation your size, and if you tell me Bell already has it, I will believe you and stop.

IF HE PUSHES ON THE PLATFORM QUESTION

We do not replace your workforce management or your contact centre platform. We run on top of them. Whatever forecast and schedule you already have, we act on what actually happens against it, in the moment.

TOUCH 6 • DAY 11 • CALL #2, SHORT

James, {{sender}} with Intradiem again. One question. When your floor runs below forecast for twenty minutes, what happens? At most operations the honest answer is nothing, because nobody can act on twenty minutes. That is the whole conversation I am asking for. Twenty minutes of yours, about twenty minutes of theirs.

TOUCH 7 • DAY 13 • PATTERN INTERRUPT, LINKEDIN MESSAGE

James, changing tack. Forget the cost program for a second. If you could hand your supervisors one thing that made their day easier rather than harder while all of this is going on, what would it be? Genuinely asking. My answer would be taking the real-time decisions off their plate entirely, but I would rather hear yours.

the last one, and the sharpest version

James, last note from me.

Bell's cost target names the call centre. Bell's own risk disclosure says staff reductions may de-prioritize the transformation those savings depend on. Read together, those two sentences describe an operation being asked to do more of the hard thing with less of what makes it possible, which is exactly the moment recovered capacity stops being a nice idea and starts being the only available answer.

Twenty minutes, or I stop here and you have my number.

{{sender}}

leaving it here

James, I will leave it.

Parting thought. Every cost program I have watched in customer operations spends its first year on deflection because deflection is measurable and fast, and spends its second year discovering that the contacts left over are the ones that were always going to need a person. The operations that come out of that in decent shape are the ones that spent year one building capacity on the floor at the same time, not after.

Bell is in year one. When that becomes the conversation, this is where I would start.

{{sender}}

Blaik Kirby

Group President, Consumer and SMB

Hook. The consumer P&L carries the service cost, and the CRTC self-service obligation lands squarely on his customer base.

TOUCH 1 • DAY 4 • EMAIL

what April 2027 does to the consumer line

Blaik, the CRTC gives providers until April 26, 2027 to let customers change and cancel plans without a live representative, and bars charging for customer service access at all. For the consumer book that is a cost obligation landing mid-way through a \$1.5 billion savings program.

The part that gets missed in planning for it is that self-serve does not lower the cost of the contacts that remain, it raises it, because what is left is what could not be automated. Intradiem works that remainder, orchestrating the contact centre and back office off real-time conditions so the harder mix does not cost proportionally more to serve.

Worth twenty minutes on how that math lands for a consumer book your size?

{{sender}}

TOUCH 2 • DAY 5 • LINKEDIN CONNECTION REQUEST

Blaik, I work with consumer operators on the piece of the CRTC self-service change that shows up after the deflection, when the remaining contact mix gets harder rather than smaller. Would value connecting.

TOUCH 3 • DAY 7 • VOICEMAIL

Blaik, {{sender}} with Intradiem. I sent a note on the April 2027 self-service deadline and what it does to the cost of the contacts that are left over after deflection. It is the part that usually surprises consumer P&Ls. Twenty minutes? I am at [number]. Thanks Blaik.

TOUCH 3 • DAY 7 • LIVE-ANSWER SCRIPT, IF HE PICKS UP

OPENER

Blaik, {{sender}} with Intradiem, thirty seconds.

THE THIRTY SECONDS

You have an April 2027 CRTC obligation to let customers self-serve cancellations and changes, and a savings target running through the same book. The trap I see consumer operators fall into is modelling the deflection savings and not modelling the mix shift. The calls that survive self-serve are the complex ones and the emotional ones, so cost per contact goes up even as volume goes down, and the savings case quietly erodes. We work that remainder, so the harder mix does not cost proportionally more.

CLOSE

Twenty minutes on how that has played out for books your size. Worth putting on the calendar?

TOUCH 3 • DAY 7 • LINKEDIN MESSAGE

Blaik, left a voicemail as well. Short version: deflection lowers volume and raises cost per contact, and most self-service business cases only model the first half. That gap is what I would want twenty minutes on.

TOUCH 4 • DAY 9 • EMAIL

the guidance, not the target

Blaik, a different angle from the first note.

Bell guided 2026 adjusted EPS growth of negative eleven to negative five percent while committing to \$1.5 billion of savings by 2028. That combination means the savings are not upside, they are load-bearing, and the market will read every quarter against them. The cost lines with the shortest distance between a decision and a result are the ones that carry that weight, and in a consumer operation that is almost always the service floor rather than the network.

Twenty minutes on the levers there that show up inside a quarter rather than across a capital cycle?

{{sender}}

leaving it here

Blaik, I will stop here.

One parting idea. The consumer operators who come out of a self-service mandate ahead are not the ones who deflect the most. They are the ones who planned for the mix that is left and built the floor to handle it before the deflection arrived, because the alternative is discovering the new mix and the smaller team in the same quarter.

Bell has about twenty months. When that becomes a planning question rather than a compliance one, this is where I would start.

{{sender}}

Francis Plante

VP Finance, Corporate Planning, Finance Transformation
& Capital Investments

Hook. He owns the economics of the transformation. The severance already spent bought a run rate that now has to be defended in the plan.

TOUCH 1 • DAY 3 • EMAIL

the run rate the severance bought

Francis, Bell spent \$517 million on severance in 2025 and reported operating costs down two percent in Q4 on the back of it. That trade is done and the savings are in the plan. What lands on corporate planning is the next tranche, because the reductions that modelled cleanly have happened and the rest of the \$1.5 billion has to come from harder arithmetic.

Recovered capacity is one of the few lines that books as cost avoided without a further reduction, which matters when your own annual information form flags staff reductions as a risk to the transformation itself. Intradiem does that across contact centre and back-office workforces.

Twenty minutes on how that models against a 2028 date?

{{sender}}

TOUCH 2 • DAY 4 • LINKEDIN CONNECTION REQUEST

Francis, I work the finance side of workforce cost programs, specifically the tranche after the reductions, where the arithmetic gets harder. Given your corporate planning and transformation remit, would value connecting.

TOUCH 3 • DAY 6 • VOICEMAIL

Francis, this is {{sender}} with Intradiem. I sent a note about the tranche of the \$1.5 billion that comes after the reductions, and where capacity shows up as cost avoided rather than headcount removed. That is a planning conversation more than an operations one. I am at [number]. Thanks Francis.

TOUCH 3 • DAY 6 • LIVE-ANSWER SCRIPT, IF HE PICKS UP

OPENER

Francis, {{sender}} with Intradiem. Thirty seconds and then your call.

THE THIRTY SECONDS

Bell has \$1.5 billion committed by 2028 and has already taken the tranche that severance buys, \$517 million spent in 2025 for a two percent operating cost reduction in Q4. What I care about is the next tranche, because it has to come from operations rather than exits, and your own filings name staff reductions as a risk to the transformation. Capacity recovered from the existing workforce is the version of that number that does not deepen the risk, and it books inside a fiscal year rather than across a capital cycle.

CLOSE

Twenty minutes to walk how that models. Not a demo, a planning conversation.

TOUCH 3 • DAY 6 • LINKEDIN MESSAGE

Francis, left you a voicemail too. Short version: the tranche of the target that comes after the severance-funded reductions has to be operational, and capacity recovery is the line that books without another reduction. Twenty minutes on how it models?

TOUCH 4 • DAY 8 • EMAIL

a risk factor worth reading twice

Francis, following up with the sentence I keep coming back to.

BCE's 2025 annual information form lists, as a risk, the de-prioritization of transformation initiatives due to staff reductions. That is the company telling investors that the mechanism funding the program may be constraining the program. From a planning seat that is the most important line in the document, because it means the next tranche cannot be sourced the same way the last one was.

Which is the whole argument for capacity over reduction, and it is a twenty minute conversation rather than an evaluation.

{{sender}}

leaving it here

Francis, I will stop.

Parting thought. Cost programs with a multi-year date on them tend to spend the first tranche on the reductions that model cleanly, and then discover the remaining tranches have to come from the operation running better rather than smaller. That transition is a planning problem before it is an operations problem, and the plans that handle it well started the operational work while the first tranche was still delivering.

When that turns into a live question for 2027, this is the lever I would look at first.

{{sender}}

Maria Ferranti

Vice President Customer Experience

Hook. Bell's containment story is genuinely strong, and she owns what happens to the experience the automation does not reach.

TOUCH 1 • DAY 1 • EMAIL

the interactions the assistant hands over

Maria, the virtual assistant numbers Bell published are good ones, 15 million interactions last year with more than half resolved without a live agent. The thing nobody puts in the annual report is what the other half feels like, because a customer who has already tried self-serve and failed arrives at a person in a different state than one who called first.

That handover is where experience programs lose ground while the containment metrics keep improving. Intradiem works the floor side, using real-time conditions to put support in front of the agent at the moment those contacts land, across the contact centre and the back office.

Twenty minutes on what typically happens to that handover at Bell's volume?

{{sender}}

TOUCH 2 • DAY 2 • LINKEDIN CONNECTION REQUEST

Maria, I work the part of customer experience that lives after containment, when the contacts the automation could not resolve reach a person already frustrated. Given your CX remit at Bell, would value connecting.

TOUCH 3 • DAY 4 • VOICEMAIL

Maria, this is {{sender}} with Intradiem. I sent a note about the handover from the virtual assistant to a live agent, and why that half tends to get harder even as the containment numbers get better. It is a floor problem more than a design one. I am at [number]. Thanks Maria.

TOUCH 3 • DAY 4 • LIVE-ANSWER SCRIPT, IF SHE PICKS UP

OPENER

Maria, {{sender}} with Intradiem. Give me thirty seconds.

THE THIRTY SECONDS

Bell resolved more than half of 15 million assistant interactions without an agent last year, which is a real result. What I would want to know in your seat is what happened to the other half, because those customers arrive at a person having already failed once, and they are more expensive and less patient than the ones who called first. Containment metrics improve and the live experience quietly degrades, and the dashboards do not show the trade. We work the floor side, so the agent taking that handover has what they need in the moment rather than after the fact.

CLOSE

Twenty minutes on how that trade shows up at your volume. Worth a look?

TOUCH 3 • DAY 4 • LINKEDIN MESSAGE

Maria, left you a voicemail as well. Short version: containment going up and live experience going down can happen at the same time, and most reporting only shows the first. That trade is what I would want twenty minutes on.

TOUCH 4 • DAY 6 • EMAIL

written confirmation on every action

Maria, one more angle, this one from the CRTC ruling.

By April 2027 every self-service action a customer takes has to come with written confirmation, and providers cannot charge for access to customer service through any channel. Read as an experience requirement rather than a compliance one, that means the self-serve path and the assisted path stop being separate journeys. A customer who self-serves and then calls will expect the person to know exactly what they just did.

Making that true is an execution problem on the floor, in real time, not a design problem in the app. Twenty minutes on it?

{{sender}}

leaving it here

Maria, I will stop here.

Parting idea worth keeping. The containment rate and the experience of the contacts that fail containment move in opposite directions almost every time, and the second one is invisible until it shows up somewhere expensive. Bell's assistant numbers say the first half is working. The question I would be asking is who owns the second half, and whether they have anything to work with beyond a report the next morning.

When that becomes the live question, this is where I would start.

{{sender}}

Melissa Kozakowski

Vice President, Customer Experience Operations, Bell
Business Markets

ENTRY DAY 2

Hook. Business markets fail differently than consumer. A missed commitment to an enterprise account is a contractual and renewal problem, not a satisfaction score.

TOUCH 1 • DAY 2 • EMAIL

business markets do not fail the way consumer does

Melissa, most of the noise around Bell's cost program is consumer-shaped, which tends to leave business markets carrying the same target with a completely different failure mode. When a consumer interaction goes badly it costs a score. When a business one does, it costs a commitment, and it surfaces in a renewal conversation months later rather than in a survey that week.

That gap is why service work on the business side has to hold under load rather than average out over it. Intradiem orchestrates contact centre and back-office execution off real-time conditions, which is the difference between catching a slipping commitment during the day and reading about it afterwards.

Twenty minutes on how that plays out across your operations?

{{sender}}

TOUCH 2 • DAY 3 • LINKEDIN CONNECTION REQUEST

Melissa, I work with business-market CX operations teams on the difference between a bad day showing up as a score and showing up as a commitment. Given your BBM remit, would value connecting.

TOUCH 3 • DAY 5 • VOICEMAIL

Melissa, this is {{sender}} with Intradiem. I sent a note on why business-market service failures cost a commitment rather than a score, and why that changes what you need from your floor on the bad days specifically. Real-time execution rather than next-day reporting. I am at [number], or the email is easy to reply to. Thanks Melissa.

TOUCH 3 • DAY 5 • LIVE-ANSWER SCRIPT, IF SHE PICKS UP

OPENER

Melissa, {{sender}} with Intradiem, thirty seconds.

THE THIRTY SECONDS

Bell's cost program gets talked about in consumer terms but business markets carries it too, with a different failure mode. Consumer failure is a score you can average out. Business failure is a commitment, and it turns up in a renewal months later. That means averaging is not good enough for you, the work has to hold on the bad days specifically. We orchestrate contact centre and back-office execution in real time, so a commitment that is starting to slip gets caught during the day rather than in tomorrow's report.

CLOSE

Twenty minutes to walk where that usually breaks across a business-market operation. Worth it?

TOUCH 3 • DAY 5 • LINKEDIN MESSAGE

Melissa, left you a voicemail too. Short version: on the business side, averaging good days against bad ones does not work, because the bad day is the one attached to a commitment. Holding under load is the conversation. Twenty minutes?

TOUCH 4 • DAY 7 • EMAIL

the back office your customers see

Melissa, a second thought, on where business-market service actually gets decided.

Order provisioning, billing corrections and change requests are back-office work that an enterprise customer experiences as service, and they are the work most likely to get quietly deprioritized when a cost program tightens, because none of it shows on a queue dashboard. Treating those queues and the phone floor as one workforce rather than two is usually where the recovery is.

Twenty minutes on how that is structured on your side today?

{{sender}}

leaving it here

Melissa, I will leave it here.

One parting thought. Business-market operations get measured on averages and get judged on incidents, and the distance between those two is where renewals are actually won or lost. A cost program pushes on the average and does nothing for the incident, so the risk goes up quietly even while the reporting improves.

When holding the bad days becomes the priority rather than improving the mean, that is the work I would want to talk about.

{{sender}}

Priya Chellasamy

Senior Manager, Contact Center AI
Technology Enablement

Hook. She sits exactly at the gap between AI that is deployed and AI that changes what happens on the floor.

TOUCH 1 • DAY 2 • EMAIL

deployed and adopted are different projects

Priya, your title is the one I look for, because contact centre AI enablement is where the interesting failure happens. The models get deployed, the dashboards light up, and then the floor keeps running the way it ran before, because nothing closed the loop between what the system noticed and what anybody did about it. You will know Bell's picture on that far better than I will.

Intradiem is the layer that closes it. We sit on top of whatever workforce management and contact centre platform you already run, take real-time state, and trigger the action, coaching, training, offline work, back-office queues, while the shift is still going.

Twenty minutes on where that loop is currently open on your side?

{{sender}}

TOUCH 2 • DAY 3 • LINKEDIN CONNECTION REQUEST

Priya, contact centre AI enablement is a title I always want to talk to, because the hard part is never the deployment. Would value connecting.

TOUCH 3 • DAY 5 • VOICEMAIL

Priya, this is {{sender}} with Intradiem. I sent a note on the gap between AI that is deployed in a contact centre and AI that actually changes floor behaviour, and the layer that closes it. Given your enablement remit I think it is a short and useful conversation. I am at [number]. Thanks Priya.

TOUCH 3 • DAY 5 • LIVE-ANSWER SCRIPT, IF SHE PICKS UP

OPENER

Priya, {{sender}} with Intradiem. Thirty seconds, technical, no pitch.

THE THIRTY SECONDS

Bell's annual report says AI-enabled quality management covers over half your care agents. In every operation I see, the constraint after that point stops being detection and becomes orchestration, because knowing an agent needs coaching is worthless if nothing schedules the coaching into a gap that actually exists. We are the execution layer for that. We do not replace your WFM or your contact centre platform, we run on top of them, take real-time state, and fire the action into the moment where it fits.

CLOSE

Twenty minutes, technical, whoever else you want on it. Useful?

TOUCH 3 • DAY 5 • LINKEDIN MESSAGE

Priya, left a voicemail too. Short version: after detection works, the constraint becomes orchestration, and that is a different piece of software than the one that did the detecting. Twenty minutes, technical, if that is interesting.

TOUCH 4 • DAY 7 • EMAIL

on top of, not instead of

Priya, worth being direct about the architecture question, because it is the one that usually kills these conversations before they start.

We are not a workforce management platform and we do not compete with one. Whatever you have for forecasting and scheduling stays. We consume real-time state from the contact centre platform and the workforce management system, evaluate rules against it continuously, and push the resulting action to the agent, the supervisor or the back-office queue. The integration question is usually the whole technical evaluation, and it is short.

Twenty minutes to walk it against what Bell actually runs?

{{sender}}

leaving it here

Priya, I will stop here.

Parting thought for the enablement seat specifically. The programs that stall are almost never the ones with a model problem. They stall because the insight arrives somewhere that cannot act on it, a report, a dashboard, a weekly review, and by the time a person sees it the moment is gone. Detection and orchestration are separate builds, and most operations only budget for the first.

If the second one comes onto your roadmap, that is the conversation.

{{sender}}

Ann Cullingham (Lee)

Director, Customer Operations

Hook. The director layer lives the daily friction and validates upward. Her entry leads on LinkedIn because the address has not resolved.

TOUCH 1 • DAY 1 • LINKEDIN CONNECTION REQUEST

Ann, I work with customer operations teams on the gap between the schedule and what the day actually does, specifically the part supervisors cannot act on because it happens in fragments. Given your operations remit at Bell, would value connecting.

TOUCH 2 • DAY 3 • LINKEDIN MESSAGE

Ann, thanks for connecting. The short version of what I do: when the floor runs below forecast for fifteen or twenty minutes, most operations lose it, because nobody can build coaching or training or offline work into a window that small by hand. We automate that in real time, contact centre and back office both. Worth twenty minutes?

TOUCH 3 • DAY 5 • VOICEMAIL

Ann, this is {{sender}} with Intradiem. I reached out on LinkedIn about the small windows in a shift that supervisors cannot act on, and how much of a day they add up to across a large operation. That is the part we automate. I am at [number]. Thanks Ann.

TOUCH 3 • DAY 5 • LIVE-ANSWER SCRIPT, IF SHE PICKS UP

OPENER

Ann, {{sender}} with Intradiem. Thirty seconds and you can hang up on me.

THE THIRTY SECONDS

You run customer operations, so you already know the thing I would tell you: a shift is full of windows too small to do anything with. Fifteen minutes here, twenty there, and a supervisor cannot schedule into them because by the time they have noticed, the window is gone. Across a floor and across a year that is a lot of day. We watch the real-time state and fire coaching, training or back-office work into those windows automatically, so the supervisor is not the bottleneck.

CLOSE

Twenty minutes to walk what that looks like day to day. Worth putting in the calendar?

TOUCH 4 • DAY 7 • EMAIL, FIRES ON VALIDATION

the fifteen minutes nobody can use

Ann, following up from LinkedIn.

The part of a customer operation I find most interesting is the windows too small to schedule. A supervisor watching a floor cannot act on fifteen minutes, so those minutes become nothing, and across a large operation they become a great deal of nothing. That is not a productivity problem in the way people usually mean it. It is a timing problem, and it needs something watching continuously rather than someone noticing occasionally.

Intradiem automates that across the contact centre and the back office. Twenty minutes on how it lands in a day like yours?

{{sender}}

TOUCH 5 • DAY 10 • BREAKUP EMAIL

leaving it here

Ann, I will stop here.

Parting thought. Most of what gets called a capacity problem in customer operations is really a timing problem wearing a capacity costume, and the tell is that the schedule looks fine on paper while the day feels short. The fix is not more people, it is something that can act inside the gaps a person cannot reach.

When that is worth twenty minutes, I am easy to find.

{{sender}}

Objection quick-handles

"We already have workforce management." Good, and we do not replace it. Verint, NICE, Calabrio and the rest are the layer we act on top of. They tell you what the day should look like. We handle what the day actually does, in the moment, and push the action to the floor. The two are complementary and the integration question is short.

"We are already deploying AI in customer service." Bell is, and the published results are real. The distinction worth drawing is between AI that resolves contacts and AI that orchestrates the workforce handling the contacts that are left. Containment and capacity are different problems and most programs only fund the first.

"We sell contact centre solutions ourselves." True, and Bell's Genesys partnership is a commercial business serving Bell's clients. This is about what Bell runs for its own 240 million interactions, which is a different question, and having deep in-house platform competency usually makes the technical evaluation faster rather than slower.

"Send me information." Reframe to a specific twenty minutes. If they hold, the Humana material is the right thing to send, and this is the only place it belongs: seven times return five years in, roughly two hours of capacity per agent per month, publicly presented and named. Never in a cold touch.

"Not now, we are in the middle of the cost program." That is the reason for the call rather than the reason against it. The tranche after the reductions has to come from the operation running better, and that work takes longer to stand up than a reduction does, so starting it late is what makes the 2028 date hard.

"Budget is frozen." Understood. Worth twenty minutes anyway, because the shape of the case matters more than the timing. Capacity recovered from existing headcount is the rare line that a frozen-budget environment can still act on, and if it fits the plan it fits next cycle rather than never.

Claims basis

Every Bell figure in this document is company-disclosed with a date, or a regulator's published decision. Sources, in the order they appear in the copy:

CLAIM	SOURCE	DATE
\$1.5B cost savings by 2028, with "new call centre and digital investments" and "improvements to the customer service experience" named as drivers	BCE Investor Day press release	Oct 14, 2025
"over 240 million customer interactions each year"	2025 BCE Integrated Annual Report	Mar 5, 2026
"AI-enabled quality management now supports evaluations for over half of customer-care agents"	2025 BCE Integrated Annual Report	Mar 5, 2026
Virtual Assistant 15M interactions, more than half resolved without a live agent	2025 BCE Integrated Annual Report	Mar 5, 2026
Risk factor: "de-prioritization of transformation initiatives due to staff reductions"	BCE 2025 Annual Information Form	Mar 5, 2026
FY2025 severance \$517M; Q4 operating costs down 2.0%	BCE Q4/full-year 2025 results	Feb 5, 2026
2026 adjusted EPS growth guidance (11%) to (5%)	BCE Q4/full-year 2025 results	Feb 5, 2026
Bibic: "simplify the business"; "lower cost to serve"	BCE Q1 2026 results and call	May 7, 2026
Self-service modify/cancel obligation, written confirmation, no fees for customer service access, April 26 2027 deadline	CRTC Telecom Regulatory Policy 2026-78	Apr 24, 2026
No activation/modification fees, billing-system transition time acknowledged	CRTC Telecom Regulatory Policy 2026-43	Mar 12, 2026
Humana: 7X ROI five years in, ~2 hours capacity per agent per month	Public SWPP/Intradiem webinar, via Value Repository, 1:many named	Replies only

Not used, and why:

- **CCTS complaint figures.** Regulator-published and directionally real, but the Bell-specific number reaches us through a secondary outlet rendering the CCTS report rather than the report itself. Not clean enough for a Bell executive. Excluded from every message.

- **Any Bell headcount, agent count or call-centre location.** Not disclosed by Bell in the Integrated Annual Report or the Annual Information Form. Third-party estimates are not usable.
- **Cumulative job-cut totals.** The individual events are verifiable from named primary sources; the cumulative figure circulating in secondary coverage is not, and one widely repeated June 2026 number appears to duplicate a November 2025 event.
- **Any idle-time or efficiency percentage.** Blocked in the Value Repository and blocked by the cost-mandate motion.
- **Any modelled ROI or savings figure for Bell.** Nothing in the Value Repository supports an account-level number and none appears here.
- **Genesys as Bell's internal platform.** Bell's Genesys relationship is a reseller and partner arrangement, confirmed for a Shared Services Canada federal contract announced Mar 3, 2026. It is not evidence of Bell's own stack.
- **RBC and Rogers Communications Canada.** Both are active Intradem customers per the Jul 10, 2026 Salesforce report. Neither is named.

Open item: BCE reports Q2 2026 on August 6, 2026. If this sequence sends after that date, re-run the cost language against what Bibic and Millen actually say on the call before anything goes out.

Pre-send gates

1. Dallas copy read.
2. Salesforce ownership and open-opportunity check on Bell / BCE, and the AE lane confirmed. Nathan's email did not name an owner for these three.
3. Mailbox warm on the sending address.
4. Ann Cullingham's email resolved in Clay, or she stays LinkedIn-only.
5. If sending on or after August 6, Q2 2026 language re-run.